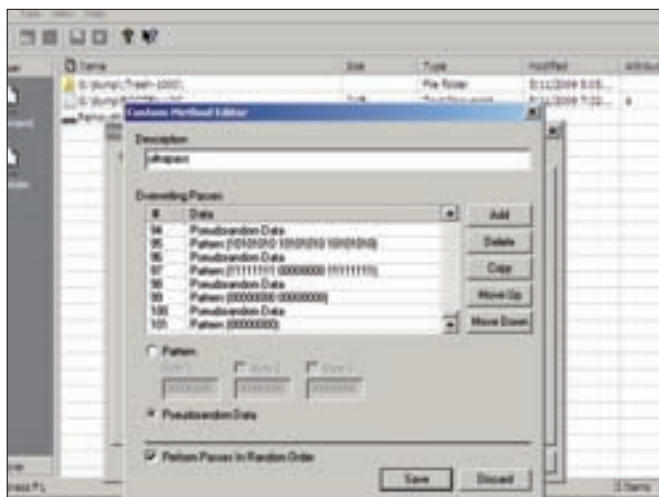




Creating a custom pass pattern

a few default patterns in which the erasing occurs, but this can be entirely tweaked by the user. The most secure default pattern offered by the program is the Gutmunn method, which involves thirty five passes.

This is more than anyone really requires. However, to give yourself the illusion of extra security, and more importantly, peace of mind, you can choose to create your own erase/overwrite patterns. Click on new to create your own pattern. You can specify an unlimited number of passes, and define what kind of data is used to overwrite the file or empty space in each of these passes. A pattern overwrite uses a specified pattern, and the pseudorandom data overwrites with random characters. We specified an operation which implements 101 passes.

Note here, that the more passes you specify, the more is the time taken. Overwriting files and folders is a relatively fast operation, compared to rewriting all the empty space in a hard disk. Even a 10 passes operation will take a long time when it comes to clearing hard disks with a lot of empty space. Also note that two or more identical passes, following the same pattern (say all zeroes) is the same as one pass with that pattern. Either alternate the pattern, or sandwich patterns